You & Me - Version 2 (Adora's POV)

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/33227167.

Rating:
Mature

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Lonnie (She-Ra), Kyle (She-Ra), Rogelio (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Life in the Horde (She-Ra), TATEOTW Prequel Story, Past Adora/Catra (She-Ra), catradora, Catradora growing up, Falling In Love, Kid Fic, Teenagers, First Meetings, Friendship, Fluff, Healing, Blood and Injury, Adora's POV, POV First Person, descriptions of physical abuse

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Part 3 of Together at the End of the World - Preqeul/Extra/Alternate Stories

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Published: 2021-08-13 Completed: 2021-08-20 Words: 13,618 Chapters: 8/8

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You & Me - Version 2 (Adora's POV)

by Midnight_Owl2

Summary

Catra and Adora often discuss aspects of their past life during the Horde: they share many good memories and some not so good. For Adora, growing up in the Horde was difficult but when she meets her best friend things start to get better. Together Catra and Adora are unstoppable but through the years Adora starts to develop strong feelings for Catra and wasn't sure what they meant... turned out she was in love with Catra, even if she wasn’t quite sure what love meant.

This series explores eight moments in Catra's and Adora past that lead up to the start of my fic: Together at the End of the World. This is version 2 of the prequel chapters under the same title: You & Me. Unlike the original version (which I’d highly recommend reading first), all chapters are written from Adora's POV rather than Catra’s. Hope you enjoy.

Notes

This works has been create after wonderful reader of mine requested that the original version of You & Me (Catra's POV) was also written from Adora's POV so we could see when Adora started to have feelings for Adora. This fic is an eight chapter prequel story to my original fic: Together at the End of the World. The first chapter is a continuation of part 1 of this series (Catra's Past). The remaining chapters may not make sense if you haven't read my original fic (Together at the End of the World) so I'd advise reading it before continuing. All chapters have the same title and tell the same stories as in the original version of You & Me but these ones are from Adora's POV rather than Catra's. Hope you enjoy reading them

This story updates everyday until all chapters are published. Please let me know what you think in the comments. Hope you enjoy :)

First Meeting

Chapter Summary

Adora finds a young Magicat in a cardboard box that had been left in the Fright Zone Corridors.

Adora gives the young Magicat a name.

Adora and the young Magicat become Best Friends and their Adventure begins.

Catra and Adora are around the ages 3/4
TATEOTW chapter connection is Chapter 4 (Alone) & Chapter 17 (Now or Never).

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Hi, I'm Adora. Do you want to be friends?"

I have never seen anyone like her before. She's probably the first of her kind to ever be in the Fright Zone. She has really colourful eyes, tanned fur with lightly colour stripes on her arms that looks extremely soft, a swaying tail and long twitching ears. Her ears in fact look a bit to big for her head… *I wonder if she'll grow into them?* I wonder what species she is… *oh wait, I bet she's a Magicat!* I've read about them before. She matches the description in the book. They have incredible cat-like features and are known for being the most powerful of all Etherian species. Some of the pictures I have seen of them are really pretty, I'd never thought I get to see one for myself.

I wonder how she got here in the first place? Why was she hiding in a box?

The small Magicat kitten leans forwards and cautiously sniffs my cheek and nuzzles against me. I think I read somewhere that this

is call *'scenting'*. I'm sure in the research that I read it said *'Magicats will do this when they feel safe and like someone. It helps to strengthen bonds between themselves and ones they trust'*. It tickles a bit.

"Hehe that tickles."

I proceeds to scratch behind the kittens long, fluffy ears and she immediately starts to make a low vibrating sound, I think it's call… *ohhh, what's it called again… 'purring'! Oh stars she's purring. I'm sure that means she's happy. It's so cute, I never thought it would sound like this.* My smile instantly grows and I start to scratch her ear more, causing the young Magicat to purr even louder. *Well she definitely likes me scratching behind her ear. I wonder how loud she can purr? Oh I wonder if I can purr?*

"What's your name?"

The young Magicat kitten stops purring for a moment and looks at me slightly confused. After a few moments she mewl in response. *I wonder what that means in Magicat language?*

"Do you not have a name?"

She either doesn't have a name or doesn't remember. *We can't have that. She deserves a name. How are people going to know who she is if she doesn't have a name. I guess we could come up with one…*

"I know, how about I give you one? Many of us in the Horde make up our own names."

The young magicat looks at me with a curious expression… I'll take that as a yes.

"Okay let's see… I'll admit I'm not great with names. Urm okay… oh I think I've got it. How about Whiskers?"

The young Magicat's nose scrunches up at the name suggested. Take it that's her way of saying she doesn't like that name.

"Okay maybe not. How about... Fluffy?"

That one I thought of on the spot because she's covered in fur, looks fluffy and cute. Unfortunately the young Magicat growls in disapproval. Take it she doesn't like any name that will make people think she's cute. That'll be something to remember if we're to be friends: *don't call new friend cute unless teasing her. You will get growled at.*

"Okay I get it, you don't like that name. No need to be grumpy at it. Okay let me think… my name ends in 'ra'. We're friends now so we want everyone to know that we're friends. You look like some sort of cat hybrid… I got it! How about Catra?"

The young kittens face lights up almost immediately, she meows at me in approval. *I guess she likes that name. N*ext thing I know, Catra jumps out of her box and lands on top of me. She starts to scent her cheeks against mine and starts purring again. *Yep, she definitely approves of that name*. I starts to giggle at her displays of affection. It's going to be difficult not calling her cute. When I can I sit up and immediately wrap my arms around Catra, pulling her into a hug. I finally have a friend…

"My Catra."

Catra snuggles into the embrace. It feels safe, nice and warm to finally have a friend. Someone I can trust, someone who I can share all my secrets with, someone who actually likes me for who I am. This may be the best day of my life so far…

"ADORA WHAT DO YOU THINK YOU'RE DOING!?"

Someone yanks Catra out of the embrace and dangles her off the ground from the scruff of my neck. I can tell from the way that Catra is moving that not only is this hurting her but she is also very panicked…

"Shadow Weaver let her go please! She's my friend."

Catra turns slightly and panic sets in her eyes when she see who Shadow Weaver is. Shadow Weaver does not look happy. Catra attempts to break free from Shadow Weaver's grasp but it's no use… she's stunned by some form of red electricity. I've seen Shadow Weaver use that as a form of punishment a few times, I have experienced it a few times myself. It's not a pleasant thing to go through. I have to stop her…

"Stop please! You're hurting her!"

My pleads are desperate, I wish there was something more I could do other than beg my mentor to stop what she's doing. Catra shouldn't be experiencing this. She's done nothing wrong. Catra manages to claw and scratch Shadow Weavers wrist before giving her a firm bite. Shadow Weaver screams and drops Catra to the ground, where she then immediately moves to hide behind me.

Don't worry Catra, I'll protect you.

"You little brat! How did you end up here? Your kind has been eliminated. Adora step aside so I can dispose of this creature immediately."

What does Shadow Weaver mean by eliminated?

Catra hisses at Shadow Weaver, her fur is completely fluffed up. Both are clear signs that she is scared but ready to fight. Shadow Weaver start to float forwards. I'm not going to let Shadow Weaver hurt her again. Catra's my friend and I'll protect her no matter what. I stand in front of Catra so she is completely protected behind me. I spread my arms out wide protecting her. I may be small but I'll do whatever it takes to protect those I care about.

"Adora don't be foolish. Stand aside before this abomination hurts you."

"That abon… *abon-i-nay-shon*... has a name. Her name is Catra and she's my best friend."

I hate having to say words that I can't yet say properly. I'm not sure what that word Shadow Weaver said means but I'm guessing it can't mean anything good.

"Adora don't be so stupid. Look at it. It can barely defend itself and Lord Hordak won't waste time training something that shows no signs of skill or intelligence."

"Then I'll teach her. I'll train her to be one of the Horde best soldiers, I promise. Please Shadow Weaver. She's… she's the only friend I have."

I've always had trouble making friends. It's not easy when everyone is older than me. They pick on me, steal my belongings like my study books and uniform. It's not my fault that Shadow Weaver has high expectations for me or the fact that I hope to become a force captain one day. I may be young but I have dreams that I hope will one day become true. I didn't choose to be here in the Fright Zone, it just ended up that way. I fight back everytime, to show them all that what they say and do doesn't upset me, but deep down it secretly does. I'll often hide in one of the spare rooms and cry for a bit, wishing for a friend who will like me for who I am. Catra is the first person I have met that seems to like me. She hasn't hit me, scratched me or nicked anything that belongs to me. She's been the nicest person I have ever met and despite that fact that she looks a little different to me she's everything I could have hoped for in a friend. I think… *I think we found each other for a reason.*

Shadow Weaver sighs and the white orbs of her mask look down in defeat.

"Very well Adora. I'm only agreeing to this as I know how difficult it has been for you to make friends, especially because everyone else is much older than you. However, this *Catra* is your responsibility. If she fails you are automatically letting down the Horde and we don't want that now do we?"

Why does the Horde have such high expectations of me? I'm only four years old, don't I get a say in what I want to do in the future? I know the Horde found me when I was a baby and Shadow Weaver reminds me everyday that I owe my life to them. I'm grateful they found me, I really am but something doesn't seem right. I may be young but I'm not stupid.

Besides me Catra makes a small mewling noise. I look down at her. She's currently on all fours trying to hide from Shadow Weaver but she's moved from behind me to lean against my side. I think this is her way of trying to comfort me. I stroke the top of my head and smile. With Catra by my side I feel like anything is possible and there is nothing to fear.

"I understand. We won't let you down Shadow Weaver."

"See to it that *you* don't."

With that remark, Shadow Weaver slowly floats away and into the distance. I release a breath that hadn't realize I was holding in. Once I'm certain that Shadow Weaver is gone, I help Catra to stand up. She's a bit wobbly at first but she eventually finds her feet... *or paws*. I pick up the box I found her in and I reach for her hand with my free one. I guide her down the dark corridor to the barracks...

"Don't worry too much about Shadow Weaver. She can be scary at times but she just wants what's best for us. Come on, I'll show you around. You can borrow some of my uniform until we get yours' sorted. It may be a bit big for you but it will do. You can have the bunk above mine if you'd like. I think you'll fit in here in no time."

Chapter End Notes

> Hope you enjoyed reading the first official prequel chapter about Catra and Adora growing up in the Horde but in Adora's POV. This one specifically links to conversations that occurred between Catra and Adora in TATEOTW Chapter 4 (Alone) and

briefly in Chapter 17 (Now or Never). I can't wait to share the remaining chapters with you. Early warning for some of the later chapters... you might want to get some tissues ready.

Please comment and let me know what you think. The next chapter will be uploaded tomorrow and we'll get to see how the original squadron first meeting went. See you then.

Drawings & The Squadron

Chapter Summary

Adora and Catra get ready to meet their new Squadron Members.

Catra and Adora decide to draw whilst they wait.

Meeting their new friends doesn't quite go according to plan.

Catra and Adora are around the ages 6/7
TATEOTW chapter connection doesn't apply to this part - I wanted to add it in for the fun of it :)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“Shadow Weaver says we’ve got some new recruits joining us today with the others being promoted to another squadron. She says that they’ll be our team for the rest of our lives. I just hope they’re nice. What do you think Catra?”

I’m so excited and nervous about today. We finally get to have a team of our own. Good riddance to the others, I didn’t like them anyway, especially not with the way they treated Catra and I. If you ask me, Octavia deserved to have her eye scratched out after what she did to Catra. I was ready to beat her up myself but Catra beat me to it. The more I think about it, the more I realize Catra's right... Octavia is a stupid dumb face.

Shadow Weaver has said that if I’m to become a future force captain I should be able lead my own squadron from a young age. I don’t understand why Shadow Weaver was adamant that Catra was to be removed from my team when this new squadron was proposed to my sergeant. Thankfully our sergeant agreed with me: Catra and I should remain together a to not break any team dynamics, not to mention that we balance each other out.

Shadow Weaver should know by now that Catra and I are a team, we look out for each other no matter what. Honestly, I don't even think we need a squadron to rule the Horde, we could do it ourselves. We're already some of the strongest cadets in the Horde, the only reason we haven't progressed any further just yet is because we're still a bit too young to progress to elite team level, but once we reach that level we'll be unstoppable.

"Who cares what Shadow Weaver says. You know I don't like her Adora. Knowing her, she might have given us the weakest members to ensure we fail. You need to relax."

"I can't relax Catra, I'm excited to meet new people but I'm also nervous about meeting them. What if… what if they don't like me? What if I'm a terrible future force captain? I don't want to fail Catra."

I can't fail, not after last time. There's so much pressure resting on my soldiers. I have to be the best of the best to prove my worth to Shadow Weaver. Last time I failed my rations were restricted from me for five day. When Catra found out what was happening she started to split her rations with me and scavenge anything she could find. It was a difficult time for us both. I never expected Catra too look out for me the way she did and yet there was no questioning it… Catra was there for me, she looked out for me, she took care of me. I can't thank her enough for everything she ever did for me. I'd be lost without her. She's my best friend, we look out for each other.

Catra startles me from my thoughts as she jumps from her top bunk and lands besides me. I wasn't expecting her to jump down.

"Adora you're my best friend. Who cares if they don't like you, you've still got me. Anyone in the entire Fight Zone would be lucky to have you as their future force captain. Really I think we could rule this place as just you and me. Besides, you're not going to fail Adora, you're too stubborn to fail. What's the worst that could happen?"

The worst that could happen is that I'd lose Catra… but I made a promise to myself long ago that I will never let that happen. She means too much to me.

"Hey, do you want to do something whilst we wait?"

"What do you have in mind?"

Catra reaches into her back pocket and pulls out two sharp coloured pens, one blue and one red. She must have found them when routing through some of the older cadets stuff that they left behind.

"Do you want to see who has the better artistic skills?"

"Catra we don't even have anything to draw on."

"Sure we do, we could draw it right here on your bunk wall." I respond giving the metal wall and bang.

"I didn't think of that."

"That's why I'm the smart one and you're the pretty one. So… what do you think we should draw?"

"How about me and you?"

"Why would you want a drawing of us on there?"

"Because we're best friends. By drawing our faces on here it will show not only that this bunk belongs to us but it will also show everyone who lives in here with us that we're best friends."

Catra and I immediately get to work, cutting into the metal with the pens edge and colouring in the gaps it leaves behind. When finished we are left with two amazing drawings of each other, or at least amazing to a pair of six year olds.

"I like them. What do you think Catra?"

“They’re alright I guess. Do you think we could trade careers from Horde soldiers to artists?”

Catra and I both start to giggle when the barrack doors suddenly open, startling us both. We stand at attention before relaxing when we notice three new figures standing before us: a young girl about our age, a young boy who may be about a year or two younger than us and some small green lizard thing on the floor beside him.

“You must be the new recruits. Hi, I’m Adora and this is Catra.”

Catra and the *'lizard thing'* seem to be in a stare off stare with each other but I’m sure that’s nothing to worry about.

“I’m Lonnie, this is Kyle and the green thing over there is Rogelio. He’s still growing but he’ll be massive and strong her he reaches his full size. He won’t even look so lizard like anymore.”

“Well it’s a pleasure to meet you all. I’m sure we’ll make a great team right Catra?... Catra?... CATRA NO!”

“What I’m not doing anything?”

“CATRA DROP ROGELIO NOW!”

“Fine.”

Catra drops Rogelio to the floor and he scurries up Kyle’s leg and into his arms, before hissing at Catra. Catra goes to hiss back at him but I calm her down by placing a should on her arm.

“Catra what was that for?” I ask calmly.

“I don’t know something came over me and I have to pounce you know.”

“Are you crazy? We’ve only just met you and your already seem like a weirdo.” Lonnie practically screams. I move forwards, fangs

bared and claws ready, but the sensation of Adora's hand on my shoulder calms me instantly.

Catra's not weird she's unique. Sure pouncing on one of the new cadets isn't the best way to start first introductions but Catra can't help it when her instincts take over. It's a part of who she is… I wouldn't want her to change for the world.

"Sorry about that. Catra's a Magicat and sometimes her natural instincts take over. Are you okay Rogelio?"

The small lizard looks up at me and nods happily. He looks unharmed, no signs of teeth marks anywhere, which is good. I'm sure Catra will apologies to him properly later.

"Who knows, maybe Rogelio will get his own back on Catra one day when he's fully grown and not so lizard-like anymore." Kyle says and we all start to laugh.

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Rogelio did get his revenge a few years later when we were twelve.

"Ah let go of me you big, overgrown lizard. I said I was sorry years ago."

"There's no way he's letting go of you Catra, you knew this was coming."

"Urgh… Adora talk some sense into your team."

"Alright Rogelio, you've had your fun, let Catra go."

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed reading the second prequel chapter about Catra and Adora growing up in the Horde. This one I just wanted to add in for the fun of it. I can't wait to share the remaining chapters with you. Please comment and let me

know what you think. The next chapter will be uploaded tomorrow and we'll get to see how Catra and Adora came across their secret spot - the watch tower platform. See you then.

The Watch Tower

Chapter Summary

Catra finds something that she wants to show Adora.

Catra has claws but Adora doesn't so they have to improvise.

Both Catra and Adora declare there new find their secret hideout.

Catra and Adora are around the ages 12/13
TATEOTW chapter connection is Chapter 18 (Promise)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Catra slow down!"

"Come on Adora, we're not far away now."

Seriously how is she this fast? I can hardly keep up.

Catra came running into the barracks earlier saying that she had something she wanted to show me before challenging me to a race. I can only just about keep up with her. I don't even know where she's leading me but it must be good if she's this excited to show me.

We've had a stressful week with training. So much so we haven't really had much time to ourselves. It's been weird not being able to have our nightly catchups. It'll be nice to be able to spend some time where it's just me and Catra again.

I'm running out of breath and have an aching stitch in my side when I finally see that Catra has come to a complete stop. Her foot taps on the floor and her tail sways impatiently. Those signs means that she's being impatient yet playful.

“Took you long enough.”

“Hey. I can’t run on my hands and feet like you can. Besides, this week’s training has really tired me out, unlike you who missed the last one.”

“What can I say Adora, work smarter not harder. We both know we didn’t need to attend that last one, it was optional, well for you it was anyway.”

I look up before looking back at Catra…

“Is this what you wanted to show me? Some big metal tower?”

“Get over yourself. The thing I want to show you is all the way up there.”

“How exactly do you expect me to get up there Catra? I don’t have claws like you?”

“Good job I came prepared then. You’re going to use this to get up there and I’ll meet you at the top.”

Catra throws me a grappling hook attached to a target gun before she starts to my climb up the structure.

“Come on Adora, we haven’t got all night.”

Typical Catra, no patience at all. I aim as high as I can and fire the grappling hook, narrowly missing Catra. It looks like a long way up. It’s a good job I’m not afraid of heights.

I eventually reach the top and Catra reaches out her hand, helping hand to get over the railing. She giggles lightly as she pulls me over… *she probably thinking about how clumsy I sometimes am and worries that I may fall over.*

“This is what I wanted to show you.”

Catra guides me over to the watch tower platform ledge that overlooks the entire Fright Zone. Vast metal structures climb to the highest point, smog and steam can be seen floating around. Some skiffs are visible as they pass through the structures below. Sure this place is a bit rusty and dull but it's home. It's the only home I've ever known, but I can't help by imagine what lies beyond the smog and mist.

"Wow, Catra this is… incredible. I never knew the Fright Zone was so big. How did you find this place?"

"Ah you know me. Always exploring."

Yeah right. Catra *exploring*, that a complete lie. I can tell she's lying by the way she smirking, the way the right tip of her ear slightly twitches and the fact that her tail is playfully swaying side to side. Over the years I have learned to read Catra exceptionally well. She doesn't even need to tell me how she feels, I can tell just by looking at the way her features move. It's cute.

"Okay you got me. I was hiding from Shadow Weaver and I found this place. I thought, *maybe*, this could be our secret hideout. No one can get up here unless they have claws like me or a grappling hook like you. No one but us has to know about this place. We could make it our special place."

Our secret place? I like the sound of that. Somewhere we can be ourselves.

Catra starts to blush and I'd be lying if I said I wasn't too. I enjoy spending time with Catra, she's my best friend. She makes me happy and I like seeing her happy too. Recently, some new feelings have started to emerge when I've been hanging out with Catra. Nothing bad, just new. It like butterflies in my stomach. I always want to be near her: she makes me smile, she makes me happy, when I'm with her I feel like I can take on the world. I haven't really had chance to research what these new feelings mean. Hopefully, having a secret spot means that I'll be able to

spend more time with Catra and work out exactly what these new feeling mean. Until then, they'll remain a mystery.

Catra's really blushing now, I don't think I have ever seen her burn up so much. It's cute and funny… *I wonder what's got her so flustered?* I gently nudge her side, slightly knocking her off balance, but it brings her back to reality and out of her daydream phase.

"I'd like that. This will be our little secret hideout."

We spend the rest of the night up on that watch tower, content with each other's company. We've been going there every night since the night it became our secret spot.

Chapter End Notes

> Hope you enjoyed reading the third prequel chapter about Catra and Adora growing up in the Horde. I can't wait to share the remaining chapters with you. Please comment and let me know what you think. The next chapter will be uploaded tomorrow and we'll get to see what Catra and Adora whispers about during their sleepovers. See you then.

Whispers

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora have a sleepover and share silent whispers long into the night.

Adora starts to feel butterflies when she's near Catra, but she isn't sure what these new feelings mean.

Catra asks a question and Adora answers, even if it's not the answer she wants to give.

Catra and Adora are around the ages 13/14
TATEOTW chapter connection is Chapter 2 (Battle of Thaymor) and Chapter 16 (Consequences)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Sleepovers are my favourite. Catra and I stay up all night telling jokes, playing tricks on Kyle and sharing silent whispers long into the night. We're currently lying side by side on my bed, both of us starting at the bunk roof. Recently I've been feeling closer to Catra… *like a lot closer*. When I'm with her I feel like I'm flying. She makes me smile, she makes me laugh, she makes me happy. She's someone I see spending the rest of my life with. I'm not quite sure what my feelings mean but one things for sure is that I like Catra a lot. I could do with finding out what these new feelings mean, besides they have been getting stronger. I'm just not sure who I can ask. It's probably not wise asking Catra about it, I don't want to freak her out. I refuse to ask Shadow Weaver, I don't trust her like I used to, something seems off about the whole Horde situation thing where she's concerned. The only other person I can think about asking is one of the other cadets. Maybe Lonnie would know what these feelings that I have for Catra mean. She seems to know a lot about, *well... stuff*. I'll give

it a little longer but if they continue to get stronger I'll have to ask someone.

Okay time to change the subject…

"That prank we pulled on Kyle today was hilarious. I never knew he was so afraid of spiders."

"I can't believe he jumped off his bunk and into Rogelio's arms. I'm surprised Rogelio didn't even alert Kyle about our prank never alone mind catch him."

"It's almost as good as the time you jumped into my arms because you saw a mouse."

Catra and I end up in a fit of laughter. That was a funny experience. Of all the things that could scare Catra I didn't think a tiny mouse would be at the top of her list. Catra's laugh always makes me smile, it also causes me to feel that butterfly feeling in my stomach and chest. There are so many things that I like about Catra. I like her voice, her smile, her little quirks that make her who she is, the patterns on her fur that I often trace when she calm and relaxed, her eyes are mesmerizing I could get lost looking at them. Above all, the one thing I love about Catra the most is who she is. She's smart, confident and amazing… there is so much about her that I love. We'd be here forever if was to list all the reason as to why Catra is… well… *beautiful.*

"Hey Adora."

"Yeah?"

"Do you ever get a weird feeling in your stomach and chest?"

"What do you mean?"

"Well, sometimes, when I'm with you, I get a strange sensation in my stomach and chest, almost like something is fluttering in there."

Wait what? Why is Catra asking this? Is she okay? What do I need to do to help? Don't worry Catra I'll help you!

I sit up panicked and start asking her a series of confused questions.

"Catra are you okay? Why didn't you tell me sooner? Should I go and get help? I don't want you to be in pain because of me?"

Catra looks at me slightly panicked but overall amused. She place both hands on my shoulders, trying to calm her down…

"Wow Adora slow down. I'm okay really. I was just asking if you know what it meant. It's not a bad feeling, it just feels strange. I've had it for a while now so it's nothing to worry about. It's actually… nice."

Catra blushes slightly at the last statement. She had me panicking then. I was ready to jump into action. Thank stars it's nothing serious and it's nothing more than a strange feeling… *a nice feeling did she say? This feeling she gets, it sounds familiar? You know what the questions can wait? Right now I just want to hug and comfort her.*

I lean forwards, pulling Catra into a bone crushing hug. She immediately returns my hug and starts to purr. Stars I love it when she purrs. It's a shame I can't purr back to her. That's a funny memory when I found out only Magicats can purr. Turns out Catra already knew this but found it funny when I tried to purr and got frustrated when I couldn't work out why it wasn't working. She said it was cute and hilarious to watch That's a special memory I'll forever hold close to my heart, just like the many memories we have already shared together. I can see us making many more special memories together in the future.

"Thanks Stars. You scared me then Catra."

"Sorry I didn't mean to scare you. All I wanted to do was to ask you if you knew what it meant."

I give Catra a tight squeeze before moving back to face her properly.

“Sorry Catra, I don’t know what it means.”

“Oh okay, well that’s fine, guess I’ll check it out with one of the doctors when I next go to the medics. Not that I ever get sick or anything.”

I hear the disappoint in Catra’s voice. I wish I had answers for her but I don’t. I know what she’s on about because I sometimes feel it too but even I don’t know what it means… *I wish I did.*

I weakly smile at Catra before lying back down on my bed. I pat the pillow beside me, asking her to lay down with me. Catra slightly giggles and rolls her eyes before laying down besides me so where now face to face. I could have sworn I heard her call me *“clingy”* under her breath.

The strange sensation that Catra was on about starts to grow in my stomach. Catra's right in terms of it’s a nice feeling… I just wish I knew what it meant. Maybe telling Catra that I know what she means in terms of this feeling may lighten her up a bit. I may not be able to give her answers but I think she’ll feel better knowing that she’s not the only one with this strange, new feeling.

“You know, now that you mention it, I do happen to know what you mean.”

Catra’s ears quickly perk up and her pupils dilate. I can hear her tail playfully batting against the barracks floor behind her. I can’t wait for her to tuck it under the blanket tonight. She always rests it across my waist, keeping me close to her. It really sweet but I’ll never admit it to her that I like it when she does that.

“You do?”

“Yeah I do. It’s like something running in circles in your stomach and I can feel my heart beating slightly faster. It’s not something

scary but it feels weird, but a nice weird. I feel it when I'm around you."

I start to feel my cheeks burning up and I notice that Catra's cheeks are doing the same. It instantly makes me feel better that I have at least been able to share some of this feeling with the person I trust the most, the person I care about the most, the person i have these feelings for.

"Adora can I ask you?"

"Anything."

Catra takes a few deep breathes before asking me what she wants to say…

"Is this what you really want?"

"What do you mean by that?"

"What I mean is do you really want to stay in the Fright Zone forever. Have you ever thought about maybe trying to escape? Getting out of here and live a free life. Explore what lies outside these walls. You know, run away together, just you and me."

I knew this question would be coming sooner or later. With everything going on, I had expected it sooner than now. I would love nothing more than to run away with Catra, be free to be ourselves, be free to live our own lives, be together for the rest of our lives. I wish it was as simple as that…

"Honestly, I have thought about it Catra. I'm fed up with feeling like I have to be the best, I have to prove my worth. There have been may times I have wanted to run away and take you with me but everytime I try I can't seem to do it. We'd have nowhere to go, the evil princesses would take us prisoner and there's no telling what they'd do to us. Right now the only place we belong is here. There is nowhere out there who would take two Horde fugitives, that's if we got out anyway. I've had to learn to accept it. The Horde found me as a baby and if it wasn't for them then I

don’t know what would have happened to me. I kind of owe the Horde my life, or at least that’s what Shadow Weaver tells me. Right now, all I want is a future where you and me are alive. It’s why I’m eager for us to work our way to the top of the Horde so we can rule Etheria together and decide what happens. I don’t know what I’d do if I lost you Catra. You’re my best friend and the only thing that makes this place bearable.”

Catra cuddles against me, her head resting against my chest. Her arms wrap around me tightly and I proceed to do the same. The thought of losing Catra scares me. I promise myself everyday that I will do everything within my power to protect her. If we could get out of this place, I would take her hand and run for miles just to be safe with her by my side, but right now our best hope is to work our way to the top and rule Etheria together. Hopefully there will be a day where everything will be better for us both.

“You don’t need to worry about me Adora. I’ve survived many things and I’ll survive many more with you by my side. I get what you mean though. You look out for me and I look out for you. As long as we have each other nothing really bad will happen. It will be me and you together at the end of the world.”

Catra and I spend the rest of the night talking, laughing and mainly enjoying being near each other. I ended up asking Lonnie what my feelings for Catra meant and she called me a *‘hopeless lesbian’*. It took me a while to understand what Lonnie meant by that but all the signs where there: the way I felt for Catra, the way I behaved around her, the fact that I wanted to spend the rest of my life with her. The feelings I have for Catra are associated with love, not that I’m sure quite yet what the word *love* means. Either way I knew one thing for certain…

I love Catra.

Chapter End Notes

Adora has to do some research into what being in love with Catra means. Hope you enjoyed reading the forth prequel

chapter about Catra and Adora growing up in the Horde. I can't wait to share the remaining chapters with you. Please comment and let me know what you think. The next chapter will be uploaded tomorrow and we'll get to see why/when Catra started to sleep at Adora feet. See you then.

Nightmares

Chapter Summary

Adora has a nightmare.

Catra finds a way to wake Adora up.

Adora asks Catra to stay by her side at night.

Catra and Adora are around the ages 14/15
TATEOTW chapter connection is Chapter 1 (Catra's Unspoken Truth)
Creator/Chapter Warning: Blood & Injury, Descriptions of Physical Abuse - All occur in Adora's Nightamre

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

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My eyes slowly open, my body aching. *Why does my head hurt?*

"Where am I? How did I get here?"

This room it looks familiar. Its quite dark and the surrounding walls are painted a blood red. There's a giant red crystal in the middle of the room… *wait a minute!*

"Ah good you're finally awake. It's time to enjoy the show?"

Show? What Show?

I frantically look around taking in my surrounds and that's when I notice Catra. Her body looks battered and she is being dangled high in the air but some sort of red electricity, attached to each of the limbs.

“CATRA!” I scream but there she doesn't answer. I try to stand but I’m immediately electrocuted back to my knees.

“AHHHH!”

“Adora why be so foolish? You should know by now that there is now escape from my dark power. Besides you brought this upon yourself.”

“W-What do you mean?”

“Oh sweet innocent Adora, you and your squadron failed your mission remember. You are their force captain and Hordak states that a team is only as strong as their leader. You embarrassed not only yourself but the entire Horde. You failed us. We all know that failures must be punished and the best way to punish you is to go for the one you care deeply for.”

“No, Shadow Weaver! Please don’t hurt her!”

Catra’s body is released from Shadow Weaver dark magic. A grunt escapes from her when she hits the ground.

This is not real. It’s not real. It’s just a dream. IT’S NOT REAL!

“Adora.”

Catra is only able to barely whisper my name, her body too weak to move. Shadow Weaver kicks Catra is the side of her ribs causing her to scream in pain. I desperately try to break free from the dark magic grasp but no matter how hard I try it doesn’t make a difference. Tears of frustration escape my eyes. I have to get to Catra I have to protect her.

Shadow Weaver continues with her unforgiving attacks, using her evil powers to toss Catra’s body across the room, causing her to scream in pain as fresh wounds start to open. I try with all my might to end this nightmare but it’s no use. I’m not even sure if this is a nightmare anymore, the pain from Shadow Weaver's evil powers feels so real.

Shadow Weaver decides to take a different approach to her attacks. She grabs Catra by the throat and lifts her off the ground. An evil smile appears across her face as Catra desperately fights for air.

"Let her go please! I'll do anything you want!"

My body starts to move but not because I ask it to. It feels as if something is trying to move me - *"Hey Adora. It's okay. It's just a nightmare. Try and wake up."*

I hear Catra's voice but it's not from the Catra that I see in Shadow Weavers grasp who speaks. Shadow Weaver evilly chuckles, refusing to listen to my desperate cries. A form a red electricity travels up Shadow Weavers arm. I close my eyes and try desperately to break free from her evil magic again and again. Catra's screams haunt me.

I have to protect her! I will not lose her! She means everything to me!

Suddenly, I feel stronger, more powerful than I have ever done before. An image of blue and gold encases my body and I break free for Shadow Weavers dark magic. I charge forward, filled with rage. Shadow Weaver drops Catra's and turns to me in shock. I take aim and…

**

A sharp pain in my shoulder causes me to awake. My arm swings round and punches something next to me…

"OUCH! What the fuck was that for?"

Who was that? Where am I? Why's it so dark in here? Where's Catra?

In my panicked state, I continue to aim in all directions. I have to get to Catra! I have to find her! I have to know that she's safe!

Something, or rather someone, gently grabs my wrist preventing me from hitting anything else. Their hands feel soft and familiar.

“Hey Adora calm down. It’s only me, Catra. You were having a nightmare.”

I immediately start to calm down at the sound of Catra’s voice. Thank stars it was only a nightmare. Catra hands lace together with mine, which somehow helps me to calm down even quicker. It takes a few minutes for my eyes to adjust but when they do they immediately find Catra’s. Her eyes are literally the light in the darkness. You can be in the darkest of rooms and her eyes will stand out a mile away. Once I’m calm and I’m able to catch my breath, I finally speak…

“Sorry I didn’t mean to wake you.”

“It’s okay Adora. I was awake anyway. I’ll just have to remember to dodge your punches when I wake you up.”

“I didn’t did I? Catra I’m so sorry. Are you okay?”

I didn’t mean to punch her, it was an accident. I’m going to have to find a way to make it up to her.

“I’m fine don't worry about it. Besides, you didn’t mean it. You were having a nightmare.”

My eyes fall to the floor and I face away from her. My body starts to tremble, *I don’t want Catra to see my cry*. I know now that it was nothing but a nightmare but they’re happening all too often. It felt so real.

“Do you want to talk about it?”

Maybe talking about it will help a bit. They’ve been becoming more frequent and maybe telling someone about them might help me feel a bit less on edge. I take a deep breath and squeeze Catra’s hands tighter. Her tails moves to gently strokes the side of my leg. It’s comforting to know she won’t pressure me to tell her

but that she's also ready to listen when I'm ready to tell her what it was about.

"Shadow Weaver has been haunting my sleep for the past few nights but tonight was the worst. Our squadron failed one of the training simulations and Shadow Weaver was angrier than I have ever seen her. However, I had expected her to only punish me as I was the leader of our squadron but no. Shadow Weaver said that the most suitable punishment for me was to hurt those who I cared about. She dragged you into that room Catra and I was forced to watch. You were in so much pain. I begged her to stop but she wouldn't listen. I tried to get to you so I could stop her but I was held down but so sort of evil power. Me sleep fighting was me fighting that evil power, trying to get to you. I failed Catra."

Tears start to fall from my eyes. I can't help it, it's all been too much. It terrified me to think that despite everything I was about to lose the person I love. Catra quickly pulls me into a tight embrace. I hold Catra even tighter and try to muffle my cries against her chest. Catra gently strokes her hand through my hair, removing my hair elastic as she goes. I know she loves it when my hair is loose and I won't lie, I feel more relaxed when I let it down.

"Shhhhhh, It's okay Adora. I'm here. I'm not going anywhere."

Why does Shadow Weaver have to haunt my dreams? Why does every nightmare involve her hurting the person I love? Isn't it bad enough that this is our reality.

After a while I start to calm down. I start to feel tired again, my body slowly starts to lean further against Catra's chest. She comfortable to cuddle. I wish she could stay with me all night. I feel more relaxed when I'm near her.

"Can you stay with me tonight please? I'm too scared to fall back asleep on my own. You help keep my nightmares away."

“Yeah I can do that. I’ll sleep at your feet though so you can’t punch me again. I’ll be right here all night long okay.”

How is Catra so... so perfect. What did I ever do to deserve someone as wonderful as her in my life? I wish I could tell her how I feel about her.

I smile at Catra before settling back down against my pillow. Catra gets comfy in her new resting spot, curling up at the side of my legs.

The nights turn into weeks, and the weeks turn into months. I still sometimes sleep fight but my nightmares haven't been as drastic with Catra sleeping at my feet. Everytime they occur, Catra gently digs her claws into my leg and I immediately awake. I tells her what they were about, we talk until I settles down and we fall back asleep. Catra thinks I haven’t noticed but I have felt her sneak up to my side some nights and fall asleep beside me. It’s taken all my power to not turn around and hug her, to hold her tight whilst we sleep. I don’t want to scare her away. I have been sleeping better with Catra near me at night. It’s a shame I can’t ask her to sleep by my side every night because believe me, I would love nothing more than be able to hold her whilst we sleep.

Chapter End Notes

> So know we know what Adora's nightmare was about. Hope you enjoyed reading the fifth prequel chapter about Catra and Adora growing up in the Horde. I can't wait to share the remaining chapters with you. Please comment and let me know what you think. The next chapter will be uploaded tomorrow and we'll get to see how Adora got her jacket. See you then.

Adora's Jacket

Chapter Summary

Catra has a surprise for Adora.

Adora can read Catra like an open book.

Adora loves her surprise and Catra gives it her own personal touch.

Catra and Adora are around the ages 15/16
TATEOTW chapter connection is Chapter 19 (Together at the End of the World)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"I can honestly say Adora that I am very impressed with your progress. Not only that but your squadron is one of the strongest that I have observed in mine time as Sergeant."

Sergeant Cobalt has called me up to discuss my squadrons progress and discuss my future hopes for one day becoming Force Captain. We've had a busy month with our trails. These trial are the most important as they will allow us to progress from elite cadets to senior cadets. Once there, we will be sent into battle, ready to fight the evil princesses and restore peace to Etheria once and for all. You'd think by now we would have at least seen some video footage of what goes on outside the Fright Zone, but no, it still remains a mystery. If you ask me that does seem a bit suspicious but I haven't had much time to question it at the moment, not with me worrying about making sure that my squadron has everything we need and not with my thoughts being filled with thoughts about… *Catra*.

I feel my cheeks starting to blush… *come on Adora focus!*

“Thank you Sergeant. I take great pride in my work and the efforts of my team. I will be sure to tell them how impressed you are with their progress. We aim to be the Horde strongest squadron and we hope to get there very soon. It’s rewarding to know that our efforts have not gone unnoticed.”

I’m not going to lie, it feels very weird that I have to speak to someone in this manner. I do not plan on speaking to anyone like this when I'm a Force Captain. It makes me feel on edge for some reason. It’s why I like my squadron, there is nothing tense about our environment. We laugh, we spar and we all get on really well, especially me and Catra. Speaking of Catra, I wonder what she’s up to? She seemed very giddy when I had to leave her earlier after training? I wonder what she’s up to?

Sergeant Cobalt grins before looking back at a stack of documents he holds in his hands and speaks again…

“That is very promising. However, Shadow Weaver has raised a few concerns and I must say that I do agree with her to some extent. We fear that your *‘sacrificial tendencies’* are playing a part in keeping your squadron’s progress at high levels. However, as there seems to be no evidence that this is what is occurring, and if it was it does not seem to be effecting you if this was the case, I will not question your training methods. However, you must remember that if you are to one day lead your squadron to victory you must remember that the force captain should be the strongest. Keep up with good work Adora. At this rate, I can see you becoming the youngest force captain in the Horde’s entire history. You are dismissed.”

With that I salute and make my exit back toward the barracks were I assume Catra will be by now.

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The walk back is a quite one. It feels weird not having Catra by my side to keep me company. It's very rare that I walk these corridors on my own now. I was surprised Catra wasn't waiting for me outside the meeting room. I wonder what she's up to?

My feelings for Catra have been quite strong recently. I did a bit of research on what love means. It's fair to say that there is little research on this topic in the Horde as fraternization is highly discouraged. What I did find though was very interesting. Turns out being in love was wonderful but also scary. It feels wonderful as I have never felt the way I do about anyone other than Catra but it's also scary because as much as I would love to tell her how I feel about her, I'm sacred to tell her at the same time. I don't know if Catra feels the same way about me and I don't want to ruin our friendship. She doesn't exactly make it clear or not if she's interested in me either. Sometime, when sparring and teasing, I think… *'maybe Catra feels the same way about me as I do about her,'* but then the more I think about it I'm like… *'this is us. We've always done this. So why does this feel different somehow?'* I'd be lost if Catra didn't want to be friends anymore. I hope that one day I'll find the courage to tell Catra how I feel about her, that I love her, but until that day I'll take comfort in the fact that she lets me hug her and she doesn't fight it. I get to tease her and just be with her. Besides, she only lets me stroke her ears and she only ever purrs for me.

I enter the barracks and immediately smile when I find Catra sat on my bed. She has her back to me. Her tail is playfully sway behind her, and her ears are bent forward, meaning that she is concentrating on something. I can't see what she is doing from this angle…

"Prefect. Adora's going to love this."

"Adora's going to love what?

Catra's ears swivel backward and her tail immediately stops swaying. Two very obvious signs that she hadn't noticed or expected my return to the barracks so soon. She jumps up and

spins around, her hands are hidden behind her back. Catra's fur starts to puff up and her tail once again begins to quickly sway side to side. Her pupils area also partly dilated, she grinning and her cheeks are starting to blush. All of those signs combined mean that's she's excited and happy. *Happy to see me I wonder?*

Over the years I have come to read Catra almost perfectly. I can tell exactly how's she's feeling and sometimes what she's thinking just by looking at the way her beautiful features move. Catra is clearly up to something and I'm going to find out what it is.

"Adora you're back early."

"Yeah, our sergeant only wanted to see me to discuss my progress for one day becoming Force Captain. He was concerned that my *'sacrificial tendencies'* are playing a part in keeping our squadron up to scratch so he wants me to work on that as he states, *'the force captain should be the strongest.'* I get what he means but a team is only as good as their leader and I want to look out for you all, we're family. Other than that, he says that I'm further ahead than expected and he could see me being the youngest Force Captain in the Horde's entire history if I keep up with training. "

"He does have a point about the putting others before yourself but I get what you mean… *Future Force Captain?* Wow Adora, that's amazing, I'm really happy for you."

"I'm happy for me to. Hang on a second, what are you hiding?"

"Who? Me? I'm not hiding anything."

"I can tell you're lying Catra. Your fur may be puffed up but you tail is swaying side to side meaning that you're excited and up to something. What are you hiding?"

"Well if you want to know so badly…" Catra runs past me, clutching something close to her chest… "you'll have to catch me first. Meet me our secret spot."

Although unexpected, I start to chase after Catra, both of us laughing as we make our way down the corridors to our secret spot that we found years ago. I've gotten a lot stronger and a lot faster over the years, but no matter what Catra can still easily outrun me. I'm not too far behind Catra and I start to my climb up the watch tower after her. Since finding this place we've added a few climbing steps in at the higher points to make it a bit safer for me to get up and down from here.

When I reach the top, Catra is waiting for me by the railing. She's is hiding something behind her back.

"Took you long enough."

"Well I wasn't exactly expecting you to make me chase you when we were back in the barracks. Now tell me, what are you hiding?"

"Close your eyes first."

"Catra…"

"Just do it, for me."

Well I can't deny doing what Catra asks, especially when she gives me the 'kitten eyes'. It's cute when smiles at me the way she is doing right now. I eventually cave and shut my eyes tightly.

"Okay now put your hands out."

I proceed to do as Catra asks and I feel her place something in my open hands. It got some weight to it but it's not heavy. If feels quite soft.

"You can open your eyes now."

I open my eyes and I'm shocked by what she has handed me. I run my hands smoothly over the gift Catra has given me.

"Catra what's this?"

“I wanted to get you something special. You know because of how well you're doing and as a thank you for everything you’ve done for us, for me especially.

“Catra, you really didn’t have to…”

“I know, but I wanted to. You're my best friend Adora and I’m going to spoil you when I can. Now come on, unwrap it so I can see you with it on.”

I untie the string and hold out my present: a crimson red jacket with the Horde logo printed on the back. It looks incredible. I’ve never seen one of these before. *Where did she even find it?* I remove my belts that rest across my white shirt and waste no time in putting the jacket on. The sleeves are a little too long but no doubt about I’ll grow into them. My belt helps to keep the jacket in place. Other than the sleeves, the jacket fits perfectly.

“Wow Catra. This is amazing.”

“Hold on, there is one more thing I need to do.”

Catra moves forward and place a claw onto the upper arms of her sleeves. She makes a slight rip in the fabric.

“Hey what was that for?”

“I wanted to give it my own personal touch… so what do you think? Do you like it?”

“Like it? Catra I love it! It’s wonderful. I’m never taking this thing off.”

“Makes you look kind of bad-ass in that jacket. I think it will suit you nicely for your Future Force Captain role.”

“I couldn’t agree more.”

Overwhelmed, I pull Catra into a warm, tight hug. I could kiss here... *not that I'm sure what one of them is yet, I read it*

somewhere... her but a hug seems more appropriate. Catra starts to purr. I love it when she purrs.

Catra's gift was so thoughtful. I never want to take it off, it's perfect. Obviously I have to take it off to wash it, but I instantly put it back on after it's dried. My squadron joke that it's my *'lucky jacket'.* I suppose they could say that but little do they know that the reason I wear it so much is because it Catra gave it to me. The fact that Catra *(the person I love)* gave me this jacket makes it even more special.

Chapter End Notes

So Adora now knows a little bit more about what Love means and what her feeling for Catra mean. She has tried to research what people in love do, particularly kissing, but she isn't quite sure how that works just yet... who knows maybe she'll find out one day 😌.

Hope you enjoyed reading the sixth prequel chapter about Catra and Adora growing up in the Horde. I can't wait to share the remaining chapters with you. Please comment and let me know what you think. The next chapter will be uploaded tomorrow and we'll get to see how Adora and Catra looked after one another when one was hurt . See you then.

Injuries

Chapter Summary

Adora helps Catra sort out her injuries.

Adora learns something new about Magicats and their tails.

Catra and Adora share a tender moment.

Catra and Adora are around the ages 16/17
TATEOTW chapter connection is Chapter 1 (Catra's Unspoken Truth) & Chapter 16 (Scars)
Creator/Chapter Warning: Blood & Injury, Descriptions of Physical Abuse

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Does it… does it hurt?"

"It's a lot worse that it looks."

"I can tell you're lying Catra."

"Okay fine. It stings like a bitch now can you please finish helping me patch it up. The sooner this is over the better."

I wish there was something more I could do to stop this. It's not fair on Catra. She didn't do anything wrong.I wish i could somehow take away her pain.

Three times this week Shadow Weaver has punished Catra. I'm not sure what the first one was for, I didn't even know about it until Catra came back to the barracks quiet and upset. Her bruises told me all I needed to know. I'm sure they sent me on a meeting mission deliberately, that way I wouldn't be able to protect her. The second wasn't even Catra's fault. All she did was beat me in a

training simulation. I was over the moon for her. She deserved it after all her hard work. She didn't deserved to be punished for doing her best. I was proud of her. Even I was shocked to find out what had happened to her and what Shadow Weaver had said. Sadly, Catra getting hurt today was my fault. We were bandaging up each others injuries from the training trails that ensure that we're on track to be the Horde's best soldiers. We were so exhausted that we instantly feel into a deep sleep after the day's events. It was nice to have Catra by my side but I never would have guess what was going to happen the next morning. We have morning patrols during this time to ensure that we're ready for anything. No one, other than Lonnie, Kyle and Rogelio, know that Catra sleeps at my feet at night. They don't know the true reason why she does that but they have never questioned it. Unfortunately for us, Shadow Weaver was sorting the patrols this morning and caught Catra and I side by side deep in our sleep. Catra was dragged to Black Garnet chamber by Shadow Weavers dark shadows, they encased her entire body. I desperately tried to get Shadow Weaver to release Catra, begging her to take me in Catra's place. I did everything I could, I tried desperately to stop what I knew was going to happen but it was no use. Eventually Shadow Weaver grew tired of my protests and she used her dark magic to strike at me, tossing me into the side wall. It was that powerful that it almost knocked me out. The last thing I remember before blacking out was Catra desperately crying out my name as she tried to get to me.

When I awoke I found myself in the barracks, alone. My head hurt slightly, and it still does, but that was nothing compared to what I know Catra was experiencing. I tried to open the door but they were sealed shut. I called for help but no one heard. All I could do was sit and wait. I cried my heart out, wishing that there was something I could do. I felt so useless. My squadron eventually returned to the barracks, a stash of extra grey ration bars were hidden under the shirts. Kyle and Rogelio handed me two, one for me and one for Catra. Lonnie informed me that for some reason their were guards outside the barrack doors and they had been informed that the doors were having *'maintenance work'* carried

out on them so they may stick sometimes until they're repaired. I knew it was all a lie. It was all to make sure that I do not escape this room. Even the air vents were sealed. This place had been made *'escape-proof'* for now. I refused to eat until Catra returned.

Time passed slowly, *unforgiving slowly,* and it was soon lights-out. About an hour later, Catra came stumbling through the barrack doors. Her fur was matted and her clothes were ripped. I immediately ran up to her and pulled her into the tightest hug I have ever given her. I could tell she was sore and hurting but she hugged me back ever so tightly. Nothing was said, nothing needed to be said, but tears were shared.

Now we're here, cleaning and patching up the wounds that Shadow Weaver has left behind. Catra has been left with a series of electrical burns across her waist, open wounds on her legs and forearms, and the tip of her tail is burnt. I wish there was something I could do to take away the pain. I would kiss all of her injuries if it was to heal them or make her feel better. I feel like no matter what I do it's never enough. I wish we could run away from all of this, be safe, be free, be able to tell Catra that I love her. I hate seeing Catra like this. I wish I could protect her somehow. She means everything to me. I love her more than anything.

I rinse out a wet flannel into a bowl of warm water beside me. This is going to hurt a little bit… "This may sting a little. You ready?"

Catra nods in response and I get to work cleaning her wounds. We've already sorted the minor injuries, many of them where cuts to her face around where her mask sits. Now we've sorting the more severe injuries. Catra hisses when the flannel makes contact with the burn on her waist and some tears escape her eyes. To my surprise Catra's tail tightly wraps around my working arm. I stop to give her a few minutes, burns sometimes sting more than open wounds.

"Sorry. Do you want me to stop?"

“No keep going. Just stings a bit.”

Catra’s tail keeps its firm grip on my arm but I don’t question it. If this makes feel Catra feel comfortable then she can do whatever she wants. I continue to clean her injuries, before drying and bandaging them up. I can sense that’s she trembling, I can feel her tail shaking slightly. I whisper quite words of reassurance and start to draw small circles through the fur on her back as I know this calms her down…

“It’s okay Catra. It’s over now. You’re safe.”

As much as I say we’re safe I know that that’s not entirely true. Things would be far better if Shadow Weaver wasn’t around. One day we’ll outrank her and I’ll be the one to make sure that she regrets everything she ever said or did to Catra. *That’s a promise.*

Catra eventually starts to calm down and opens her eyes once more. Stars her eyes are beautiful, I'm surprised I haven't got lost in the sight of them. Catra suddenly startles and she recoils her tail, her fur puffs up. Her ears now lie flat against her head. I take it she’s embarrassed by the fact that her tail was wrapped around my arm.

“Sorry, I-I didn’t mean to grab you with my tail.”

“It's okay. I actually quite liked it. Felt nice, comforting. Catra can I ask you something? Why did your tail *‘unconsciously’* wrap around my arm?”

“I’m a Magicat Adora. Magicats react differently to other species when in pain. One of them being… *wrapping our tails around the people we trust*.”

‘People we trust?’ I can’t help but blushes at the statement. It's cute and sweet. I move closer towards her so we almost shoulder to shoulder.

“You know that's kind of cute right.”

"I am *not* cute!"

"SHHHH! Keep your voice down. Do you want to wake the others?" I can't help but giggle. Catra is very cute even if she doesn't want to admit it.

When Catra looks back at me she appears more relaxed. *Stars she's beautiful, she always has been.* Catra has always been pretty… *well attractive*… but the more time I've spent with her I came to learn that Catra is beautiful on the inside and outside. She's unique. I have never felt this way about anyone else but her. There's something about her that I can't quite describe.

"Well I liked it and it isn't something you should be embarrassed about Catra. You look out for me and I look out for you. I'm glad you trust me. Now how about we get some sleep. You can stay down here if you want but you'll have to remember to get up before morning comes. I hate seeing her doing this to you Catra, I wish there was something more I could do."

Running away and leaving the Horde behind is an option but my mind plays a series of worries on a loop: *we'd have nowhere to go, the Horde may even track us down… it's practically a death sentence.* I hope that one day we'll be able to get out of her, together, and live our lives. One day, I hope that I will finally have the courage to tell Catra that I love her, I can only hope she feels the same way about me.

Catra nuzzles my cheek and starts to purr. She hasn't scented me for a while; it's comforting when she does this. It's like she trying to tell me something that she can't quite put into words. I might not be able to purr but maybe, just maybe, there is something I can do. Something that I have been longing to do for a long time now. Something that will show Catra how I feel about her, how much I care about her.

When Catra moves back ever so slightly, I look deep into her mesmerizing eyes. I can sense my cheeks starting to blush as a soft smiles appears across my face. I start to gently scratch

behind one of Catra's ears. Guided by instinct, I slowly start to move forwards, giving Catra the chance to pull away if she wants to. I pause for a moment, hauling my scratching behind Catra's ear. When Catra doesn't move away, I move forwards once more and place a gentle kiss to her cheek. I may not be able to tell Catra how I feel about her just yet so I hope this shows her how much I care about her.

"Goodnight Catra. Wake me up if you need me."

With that I tuck myself into my blanket. I feel Catra curl up against my legs a few moments later, her tail resting across my knees. I want nothing more than be able to tell Catra how I feel about her, that I love her… *that I have always loved her.*

Chapter End Notes

> Hope you enjoyed reading the seventh prequel chapter about Catra and Adora growing up in the Horde. I can't wait to share the final prequel chapter with you. Please comment and let me know what you think. The final chapter will be uploaded tomorrow and we'll get to see the last time Catra sang to Adora. See you then.

One Last Song

Chapter Summary

Adora isn't feeling well.

Catra takes care of her.

Catra sings to Adora for one last time?

Catra and Adora are around the ages 17/18
**TATEOTW chapter connection is Chapter 13 (New Plan) **
Creator/Chapter Warning: Descriptions of Physical Abuse

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"I've - **cough** - got to get to - **cough** - training."

"Adora stop! You're not going anywhere like this. You can barely stand let alone mind compete in combat training. You're staying put."

I hate this, I hate being sick. I'm currently wrapped up in a blanket on my bed with Catra by my side. I started to feel unwell as few days ago. My muscles were aching and head felt heavy but I thought nothing of it. Besides,you can't show any signs of weakness when you're in the Horde. If you're sick you either get on with it or you hide and tell no one. *Unfortunately for me,* today got the better of me. I've contracted a bad case of *'Fright Zone Fever'*.

What's Fright Zone Fever? It's basically a sickness where you have extreme nausea, become seriously dehydrated, have a high fever, get a slight cough and cold and your muscles feel like they have been stretched beyond their limits, making it almost impossible and defiantly painful to move. The fever takes hold gradually and then hits you all at once. It's called *'Fright Zone Fever'* as it occurs

when cadets are under extreme pressure and become exhausted from hard-core training regimes. It's only ever been witnessed in the Fright Zone.

I'm not sure if Catra has ever caught *'Fight Zone Fever'*. She always jokes about how Magicats have incredible abilities and heightened immune systems, but sometimes I can help but think their more facts that jokes. I'm placing bets on the fact that Magicat's are secretly some of the most powerful species on all Etheria. It's a shame that we'll probably never find out if that's true or not because Catra is the only living Magicat that I've ever seen... *who knows if there's more of her species out there?*

Right now I don't care how sick I am, or how exhausted I am or how painful my muscles ache, I have to get to training. If I don't Shadow Weaver will kill me, or worse. I won't let her have any reason to harm Catra, simply because she's taking care of me. Catra doesn't have to but she insists on staying with me. It's just the way she is… *I'd do the same for her.*

"Catra if I don't go Shadow Weaver will kill me."

"No she won't because I won't let her."

"Alright but please at least let me try and go to training Catra. If not for myself then for our squadron."

"Technically it's *your* squadron Adora. You're the one who's on track for Force Captain. However, if you insist on going to training, stand up without my help and if you can remain standing then I'll let you go to training with the others."

Finally! I grumble sightly as I start to shift positions off my bed. My muscles would be screaming right now if they had voices, they feel like they're on fire. I could have sworn I just heard Catra snicker under her breath. Of course this would be amusing for her. I probably look a right mess. Guess what, I'll be the one laughing when I get up and prove her wrong. I have to stop every so often to allow my muscles to adjust to this new position. It's very

uncomfortable to say the least. Once fully stood, I lets go of the bunks' metal frame and smiles triumphantly.

“See told you I could…”

A wave of nausea washes over me and my legs start to wobble.

Shit, better get ready to face plant the floor.

Catra rushed forward and holds me up with her arms. After a few minutes, the nausea passes and I’m able to see clearly again. I look up to find Catra giving me her *‘I told you so’* look. Dammit, I hate admitting she’s right…

“Okay maybe you were right.”

“I’m always right dummy. Now I’m going to tuck you back into bed then I’m going and see if I can get you some ratios soup and medicine to help with your temperature.”

I merely nods in response and Catra gently lower me back to the bed. She drapes my blanket over my waist rather than tucking me in completely; I guess my temperature is up and that's why I felt like I was going to be sick.

I hate feeling vulnerable. I don’t think I’ve ever been this sick before. It makes me feel weak, unless… I feel like a burden.

I can feel a shiver coming on. *Yep my temperature is definitely up*. Catra looks at me concerned and goes to stand up from her kneeling position next to me. I reach out and grab her hand. I don’t want her to leave me but I know she’s probably going in search of something that’ll make me feel better.

“Don’t be too long please?”

Catra uses her claw to brush a strand of loose sweaty hair out of my eyes. She smiles down at me. I can sense that she doesn’t want to leave me either but she knows that if I am to get better, I’ll soon need access to water and medicine.

“I’ll be back as quick as I can, I promise.”

Catra gives my hand a gentle squeeze before leaving the barracks. My eyes remaining fixated on the door the entire time, awaiting her return.

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Catra keeps her promise and returns not long after she left. However, the way I’m feeling right now means that I have no idea how time is moving, he may have been gone longer than I thought but who cares, she back now by my side. That automatically makes me feel better. Catra has made sure that I have some medicine, some water and ration bar soup. It hurts slightly to drink and eat but I know it’s better than nothing. If I’m to get better sooner rather and later I had to get some fluids into me. The pain killers have helped with my muscle aches and temperature. I feel more alter now but I’m still very clearly sick. Catra has just removed the cold, wet flannel from my head. Take it that’s a good sign. I can finally curl up against her now without worrying about my sweating shivers soaking her fur.

Finally, I’m able to cuddle up to Catra. My arms wrap around her waist, holding her close to me, whilst I rest my head against her chest. The sound of her strong, steady heartbeat helps me to relax. Catra’s so comfy, fluffy and warm. I love cuddling up to her. It makes me feel safe and loved. I know Catra’s worried about me, I hope cuddling up to her knows that I’m grateful of everything she has done for me. I’d be lost without her.

Catra starts to stoke through my lose, long blonde hair. I know what she’s trying to do. She’s trying to get me to relax even more so I’ll fall asleep. I can feel my eyes getting heavy. I suppose if I could sleep, even if it was only for a short while, I might start to feel better.

“I’m sorry Catra.”

“What-What you sorry for?”

“For being sick. Putting you in this position…”

“You’re such an idiot. Adora you can’t help getting sick. To be honest, I’m surprised you manged to hide it this long. You lasted longer than I thought.”

“Still I’m putting you behind in training because you're taking care of me. You can leave whenever you want. I don’t want you to fall behind.”

“Adora stop being such a dummy. You’re my best friend. We promised to look out for each other and that’s exactly what I intended to do. I intent to keep my promise. You’d do the same for me. Besides, I’m not falling behind in training. Have you seen my scores recently? I'm tied with you. If anything it’s the other who need to catch up, Kyle especially. He’s just, wow he’s really far behind compared to us now I think about it.”

I can’t help but giggle but it doesn’t help my case much as I end up coughing again. Catra hands me a glass of water which I end up gulping down. My throat is really dry it hurt…

“Slow down. The faster you drink the more sore your throat will be.”

Catra’s right. The fast I drink the more aggravated my throat will become. I slow down my drinking and pass my glass back to Catra when finished.

“Thanks” I says before leaning back against her chest and snuggle into her. I’m sure I hear Catra giggle slightly as I attempt to get as close to her as possible. If I wasn’t so sick, she’d probably make one of her sarcastic remarks about me *‘trying to bury myself into her fur’.* She can laugh all she wants, I know she finds cuddling just as comforting as I do.

"I'm worried about you Adora. I've never seen you this sick before."

"Don't worry about me. I'll be okay. It's like you said. It's just a bad case of Fright Zone Fever. I'll be over it in a few days. Beside, I'm being well looked after. I don't know what I do without you Catra."

Catra knows I'm right, but I know no matter what I say she'll still worry about me. I can't tell her to not worry though, I worry about her too. I worry about her even when there probably isn't anything to worry about. It's part of being in love with your best friend. I wish I could tell her how I feel about her. Honestly I'm surprised I haven't already blurted it out with me being this sick.

"Hey Catra?"

My voice still sounds a bit groggy but better than it did an hour ago. I'll take that as an improvement.

"Yeah Adora."

"Can you maybe... *sing to me please*. It helps me to relax and you have a really nice singing voice."

I feel slightly embarrassed to ask this of Catra, so much so I actually start to blush a little. It's no secret that I love it when Catra sings to me, I tell her all the time. I have always loved Catra's singing voice. It helps me to relax, makes me feel at peace. She's only ever sang to me. She has a beautiful voice that I feel she should share with the world. One day I hope she will. Until that day, I will gladly keep Catra's little secret to myself, as secret that only I am allowed to hear.

Catra giggles slightly and start to hum a gentle tune from a song that she has sang to me many times before. Catra started to sing to me a very long time ago, often after I awoke from a really bad nightmare and was panicked from what had happened, even if it was nothing but a dream. The first time I caught her fully singing her heart out was on the watch tower when we were fifteen. She

was signing a song, a song that I had never heard before, that was about loving someone but being unable to tell them how you felt for them. It was beautiful, it was the first time I had ever heard her properly sing. She hadn't noticed me until I slipped slightly, causing the rail to rattle. I wish I hadn't slipped, I was hoping she would say who the song was about… *I was hoping it was a song sang about me. Guess I'll never find out.* I can't exactly remember when I first heard this song but it was many, *many* years ago. Thankfully, Catra wasn't mad at me and started to sing to me more after that night. She never sang that song from that night again in my presence but I have heard her sing it every so often when walking past the showers. I suppose it's also my fault as I have never asked her to sing it again for me… *even if it has left me with a few unanswered questions.*

My body starts to relax against Catra's in a matter of minutes, but not before I feel Catra's tail wrap around my waist.

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I recon a few more hours have passed when I starts to awake. My arms automatically tighten around Catra's body and I blindly nuzzles further against my chest. Catra starts to purr and I feel her hand starting to rub gentle circles on my back, coaxing me to wake up slowly. It takes me a few minutes to fully awake, but when I do I feel better than before… *that's probably because Catra was next to me whilst I slept.*

"Hey sleepyhead. How you feeling?"

"Better than before but still not great. Thanks for staying with me."

I move to sit up slightly and rubs my dry eyes clear from sleep. Catra hands me a glass of water and I takes a few sips. My throat isn't as sore now, I can smile without it hurting. After a few more

sips of water, I turns to look at Catra but my smile drops instantly. Her neck is bright red and slightly swollen. I can see a few scratch marks hiding under her fur. They're not claw marks and they're definitely not old scratches either.

"Catra what happened to you neck?"

"Oh this? Ah it's just a scratch or something. Nothing to worry about."

"It doesn't look like *'its nothing to worry about'* to me."

My hand gently brushes against the fur on her neck, carefully assessing the reddened area. It must be sore to touch as Catra holds back a whimper when I touch a specific area. I only need to guess who did this too her…

"I'm fine really Adora."

Before I can respond the squadron enter the barracks. They must have finished training for the day. I give Catra the *'we'll discuss this later'* look and I start talking to the team, acting like nothing happened. They all keep their distance as they don't want to catch the fever. They should know that's not how *'Fright Zone Fever'* works. It's an airborne virus. They all suffered from it a week later… *all except Catra that is.*

When you're in the Fright Zone, it appears that there is no escape from anything.

Catra eventually ends up telling me about what happened with Shadow Weaver. I've felt guilty ever since. I should have gone to training regardless of how sick I was. I shouldn't have been so selfish as to ask Catra if she would sing for me. Catra has reassured me that what happened was not my fault, it was *'just Shadow Weaver being a jealous bitch'*, but I can't help but believe that it is all my fault.

Since then Catra hasn't sang for me, she's only purred. I miss her singing but if it means she is safe then so be it. I'd don't want her

to suffer because of me. I'll do anything to protect her. I will be the one who will love and protect her for the rest of my life… that's my silent promise to Catra… *my Catra.*

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed reading the final prequel chapter about Catra and Adora growing up in the Horde. Please comment and let me know what you think. The reason why there is a question mark (?) at the end of the last summary text is because I feel that Catra would immediately start singing for Adora after the ending of my original fic: Together at the End of the World.

Unfortunately, this prequel chapter concludes all works connected with my original fic: Together at the End of the World. Thank you to all my incredible readers for joining me on this incredible journey. I hope you enjoyed reading the prequel You & Me from Adora's POV. I really enjoyed writing it. I have enjoyed sharing these prequel stories with you. On the bright side, the end of this works mean that I can start planning my next fan fic. I hope to see you soon. :)

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!